It was strange that the SIT never bothered to interrogate Nagarajan even after he was put behind bars. By the same yardstick, the SIT was not pursuing the trail that could have led them to the RDX supplier Murugan had sourced from, in spite of reminders from the CBI's second in command, S.K. Datta. The SIT reported to Datta and Karan. According to sources, the denim vest bomb carried six grenades.[8] From the remnants of the blast, the explosives expert of the NSG had identified SFG-87 made in Singapore, clearly establishing the foreign links of the assassins. Yet Datta's reminder was not considered. Detection of the supplier of the explosives would have only added value to the charge sheet.

Based on inputs from the intelligence agencies, Datta had given a list of individuals whose role in the conspiracy warranted investigation. One of them was Kumara Padmanabha, popularly known as KP. He lived in Switzerland. Reportedly, Interpol had shared a report on KP's activities with the SIT that underlined his role in acquiring logistics for the LTTE, including procurement of arms and ammunitions, and means of transport, including a ship called *Tong Nova*, which he had sent to ensure safe passage to Rajiv's assassins. The ship was intercepted by the Indian navy off the Karaikal coast near Pondichery (now Puducherry) and blown up mid-water when the occupants of the ship refused to surrender. Kaarthikeyan later wrote in his book that the SIT had information that 'KP had telephonically intimated to a Sri Lankan Tamil based in India in November 1990 that the LTTE would attack the Indian leadership. Based on this vague information, it was not possible to charge KP in the Rajiv Gandhi case.'[9]

But stories of people pulling strings from beyond Jaffna were gaining ground even as the divide within the SIT was becoming clear. A couple of members started looking for KP, who, besides handling money and arms purchases, held accounts in at least four branches (London, Cayman Islands, Panama and Frankfurt) of the BCCI, and another bank in Singapore was used regularly to pay off arms dealers operating from Panama, Cyprus, Honduras and Singapore.

Anirudhya learnt that a CBI team would be visiting these countries to further probe the matter. Inquiries were also being made with banks to